

Percy Shengjun Zhai

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Education

The University of Chicago Booth School of Business , Chicago, IL Ph.D. Econometrics and Statistics	<i>2021 – 2027</i>
The University of Chicago, Department of Statistics , Chicago, IL M.S. Statistics	<i>2019 – 2021</i>
University of Science and Technology of China , Hefei, China B.S. Physics, Special Class for the Gifted Young	<i>2015 – 2019</i>

Research Interests

Time Series, Bayesian Inference, Graphical Models, and Simulation-Based Inference

Publications

[Simultaneous Inference for Covariance and Precision Matrices of Long-Range Dependent Time Series](#)

Percy S. Zhai, Mladen Kolar, and Wei Biao Wu (2026)
IEEE Transactions on Information Theory, 72(6): 4246-4296

[High-dimensional Gaussian Graphical Model Testing for Long-Memory Time Series](#)

Percy S. Zhai, Ping-Shou Zhong, and Wei Biao Wu (2026)
Accepted to the 40th Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems

[Conditional Flow Matching for Bayesian Posterior Inference](#)

Percy S. Zhai*, Sowon Jeong*, and Veronika Ročková (2026)
The 29th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics, PMLR 300:2044-2052

[Deep Generative Quantile Bayes](#)

Jungeum Kim, **Percy S. Zhai**, and Veronika Ročková (2025)
The 28th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics, PMLR 258:4141-4149

[High-dimensional Functional Graphical Model Structure Learning via Neighborhood Selection Approach](#)

Boxin Zhao, **Percy S. Zhai**, Y. Samuel Wang, and Mladen Kolar (2024)
Electronic Journal of Statistics, 18(1): 1042-1129

Working Papers and Preprints

[Horseshoe Predictive Inference](#)

Percy S. Zhai and Veronika Ročková (2026)
Under Review by Journal of the American Statistical Association, Theory and Method

[Valid and Efficient Split Conformal Regression for Time Series](#)

Percy S. Zhai, Maggie Cheng, and Wei Biao Wu (2026)
Under Review

[Conformal Coverage of Time Series: Validity and Inference](#)**Percy S. Zhai**, Maggie Cheng, and Wei Biao Wu (2026)

Under Review

Testing Demographic Parity Gap on Precision Graphs for Sub-Exponential Time Series

Percy S. Zhai, Mladen Kolar, and Wei Biao Wu (2026)

Under Review

Two-way Guidance: Simultaneous Learning of Summary Statistics for Generative Bayes

Percy S. Zhai, Max Pachman, Peverel Shipley, and Jungeum Kim (2026)

Under Review

Possibilistic Radial Transport for Approximate IM Inference with Hypothesis Comparison and Selection

Jungeum Kim and **Percy S. Zhai** (2026)

Effects of Dropout Regularization on Memorization in Diffusion Models

Percy S. Zhai, Molei Tao, and Jiaqi Li (2026)**Awards**NSF-SBIES 2026 Travel Award, National Bureau of Economic Research *May 2026*BNP14 Travel Award, The 14th International Conference on Bayesian Nonparametrics *June 2025*[Arnold Zellner Doctoral Prize](#), The University of Chicago Booth School of Business *May 2025*NSF-SBIES 2025 Travel Award, National Bureau of Economic Research *May 2025*Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Chicago Booth EMBA AXP-23 and EXP-29 *May 2024*Ph.D. Program Fellowship, The University of Chicago Booth School of Business *2021 – Present*Student Scholarship, Physical Sciences Division, The University of Chicago *2019-2020***Presentations****Invited Talks**Joint Statistical Meeting 2024 *Portland, Aug 2024***Contributed Talks**2026 NSF/CEME Seminar on Bayesian Inference in Econometrics and Statistics *Seattle, May 2026*Joint Statistical Meeting 2025 *Nashville, Aug 2025*BNP14 Workshop on Bayesian Predictive Inference *Los Angeles, Jun 2025*2025 NSF/CEME Seminar on Bayesian Inference in Econometrics and Statistics *Philadelphia, May 2025*The Bayesian Young Statisticians Meeting 2025 *Online, Mar 2025***Contributed Posters**14th Conference on Bayesian Nonparametrics *Los Angeles, Jun 2025*Conference on Advances in Time Series Analysis *Chicago, May 2023*2023 Midwest Machine Learning Symposium *Chicago, May 2023***Student Seminars**Booth Econometrics and Statistics Student Seminar *Chicago, Apr 2025*Booth Econometrics and Statistics Student Seminar *Chicago, Feb 2024*

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant

Contemporary Bayesian Inference (Booth PhD Course)	<i>2026</i>
Data Intelligence (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2025</i>
Big Data (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2025</i>
Business Statistics (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2022 – 2025</i>
Statistics (Booth EMBA Program, London and Hong Kong)	<i>2023</i>
Statistical Insight into Entrepreneurial Quantitative Consulting (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2023 – 2024</i>
Statistical Insight into Marketing, Consulting, and Entrepreneurship (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2021 – 2022</i>
Machine Learning (Booth MBA Elective)	<i>2021</i>

Academic Services

Referee for Journals

Annals of Statistics
Journal of the American Statistical Association, Theory and Method
The Journal of the Royal Statistical Society, Series B

Reviewer for Conferences

AISTATS 2027, ICLR 2027, NeurIPS 2026, NeurIPS 2025, UAI 2025, ICML 2024, and NeurIPS 2023